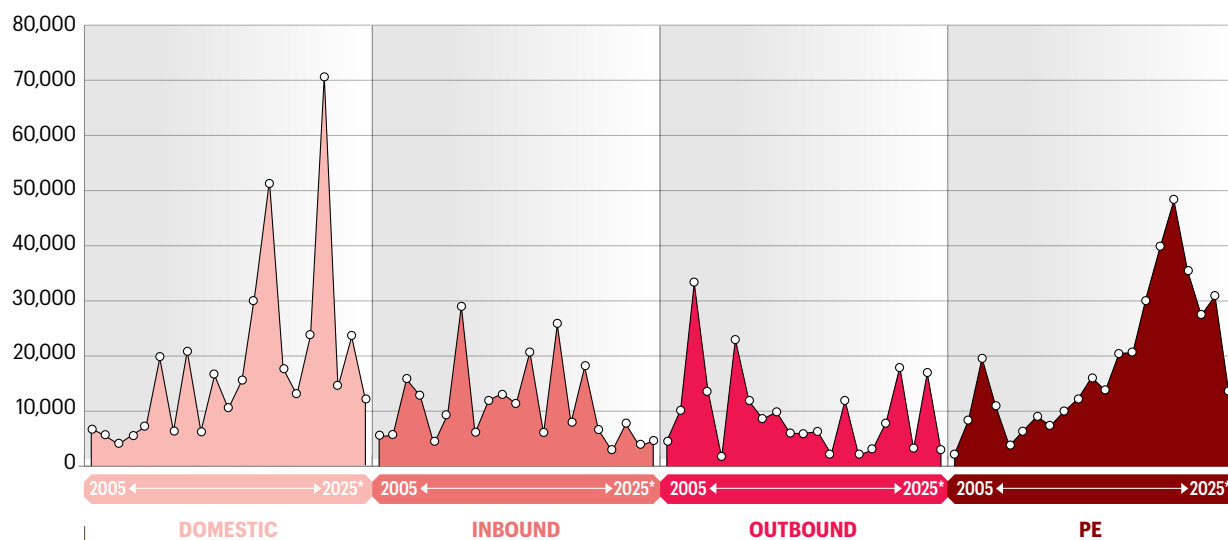


THE M&A STORY

- **M&As work for companies from sectors like automobiles, infrastructure, FMCG, among others, while players from the IT/ITES sector are keen on joint ventures, partnerships, or collaborating with overseas companies**



NOTE 2025* TILL MAY 2025; FIGURES IN \$MILLION; PE IS PRIVATE EQUITY

SOURCE GRANT THORNTON

technology around the world. That was a big tipping point since it gave us the confidence to accelerate, get into every market and go after businesses there,” he says. India’s unique advantage was in its deep pool of English-speaking, technically skilled talent that could deliver quality software services at a global scale and competitive costs.

For companies, the global journey is fraught with challenges, requiring them to navigate multicultural environments and adapt to unpredictable regulatory landscapes. Big buyouts in a sector like pharmaceuticals, difficult in the best of times, come to mind. The Mahindra Group had its own set of challenges with SsangYong, a South Korean automotive brand it bought in 2011. In late 2020, SsangYong filed for bankruptcy,

followed by Mahindra selling its stake, two years later, to a consortium led by Edison Motors. The key lesson in cross-border buyouts across companies comes down to how companies get it right on timing, cultural integration and dynamics of evolving markets.

During this global journey, the perception of India Inc has strengthened. Dipali Goenka, MD & CEO, Welspun Living, points out that India has moved from the periphery to the core of global business. “Our companies are now being recognised as high-value strategic partners and not just cost-efficient manufacturers. This shift has been driven by a sharper focus on technology, sustainability and consumer-centric thinking, making our products more relevant and desirable across

markets,” she says.

Emphasising the point that her company has been the highest exporter of home textiles from India for 13 years in a row, Goenka speaks of her company’s strong relationships with large retailers across the US and Europe, among other key markets. “We recently launched a state-of-the-art facility in the US, reinforcing our commitment to being locally relevant and globally competitive.”

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Without doubt, 2047 is more than just a landmark year in view of the government’s Viksit Bharat target. Goenka says companies must place technology and innovation at the heart of the strategy, “whether it is adoption of AI, advancing clean energy solutions